



Making the Most of Social Media

Thanks to social media, your business can engage with existing and potential customers anytime, anywhere. To make the most of it, you need to target the right platforms and use the most effective strategies.

Picking the right sites

Start by deciding what you want to achieve on social media, such as building your brand, reaching new customers, or engaging better with existing ones. Review the platforms your competitors use and why; this will help you decide which are most relevant for you and may inspire new ideas. To further guide your choices, ask your customers which platforms they use, and compare any profile you have built up of them—plus of those you aim to attract—to the user demographic information found in the business tools on most popular platforms.

Once you have decided your plan, you need to bring it to life. Start by creating compelling content, such as posts, images, or videos, and post it on the most appropriate platforms (see right).

Creating a strong profile

Begin by choosing a username, which starts with the @ symbol, called a “social media handle,” for instance, @mycompanyname. Aim for a strong, consistent username across all platforms and ideally one that matches your website domain name (see p.114). Use the same logo or personal photograph across all platforms, too, so that your business is easily recognized. Then, add an attention-grabbing summary of the business and keep it updated.

SHARE CONTENT ACROSS DIFFERENT PLATFORMS

- › **Repeat consistent messages** but reshape content to suit different platform styles.
- › **Tweak messages** to suit the vocabulary and the tone of each platform.
- › **Boost impact** by using the full character limit for each platform.
- › **Check images** and resize them as necessary for each platform.

EXTEND BUSINESS REACH

- › **Target the maximum** number of users who see your content.
- › **Use hashtags**—“#” followed by words with no spaces, such as #hotdog—to create phrases that are easy to search for, including your business name.
- › **Encourage engagement**, using likes, comments, and shares.

Choose the right social media

Six key sites; look out for new ones, too.

- › **Facebook**—use to showcase your products and services.
- › **Instagram**—share videos and photos, and engage with customers.
- › **Snapchat**—post to 12–34 age group, and offer discounts and promo codes.
- › **Twitter**—post breaking news, announcements, and promotions.
- › **LinkedIn**—post professional content, as well as jobs, to build credibility.
- › **YouTube**—post educational and instructional videos.



EXISTING CUSTOMERS

Engaging with existing customers can result in repeat sales and greater loyalty.